AI ACADEMIC WORKING GROUP_REVISED DRAFT RECOMMENDATIONS_FOR DISCUSSION

Revised Recommendation 1: Expand AI literacy resources for faculty and students

Resources are available for faculty and students to increase their AI literacy. However, uptake is limited, and resources are not available to meet all levels and types of need, ranging from novices seeking to understand the impact of AI on teaching and learning in disparate fields to those at the forefront of teaching and learning on the topic of AI. Expertise is resident at the university, but it is distributed, and no single unit is responsible for producing teaching and learning resources for the full university community. A coordinated central and distributed structure will create more effective, consistent, and efficient support for teaching and learning in the era of AI across the university.

- Work with academic leaders to convene and charge a consortium of central (UOES) and distributed instructional designers (chancellor-led units, schools) to act on resource priorities identified by the AI Academic Working Group, a group that includes faculty, staff and administrators. The consortium would be managed as a workstream within the Academic Technology Advisory Council, an advisory group to the EVPAA and CIO with provost-appointed group members.

  Alternatively, a single group could be charged with responsibility for producing general resources for the full university community. This would require an expanded charge for an existing team or the creation of a new team as there is no current group with this mandate (see new investment bullet below).

- Establish a faculty fellowship program that pairs faculty and instructional designers in the development of new high-priority teaching and learning resources for the entire university community and integrate with university wide efforts outlined above.

- Invest in more university wide instructional design staff to add expertise and capacity for general resource development for AI in teaching and learning. These staff could report through CLU-based teaching and learning groups and/or through central groups with an expanded mission (e.g. University Online Education Services (UAA with dotted line to OIT), Academic Technology (OIT with dotted line to UAA)).

Revised Recommendation 2: Clarify and disseminate university guidelines on the use of AI

Clarify general instructional use guidelines for AI technologies (e.g., limited to university-approved tools) with the expectation that best practice for instructional use will be the purview of the academic units (campus, schools, departments) and that course-level adoption will remain at the discretion of the instructor. This central and distributed approach to policy, guidelines, and best practice is the approach taken by the majority of our peer institutions.

Below are draft best practice guidelines for the responsible use of AI tools in teaching and learning: one designed for students and the other for instructors. Proposed best practices were developed by the AI@Rutgers Academic Working Group in collaboration with instructors, students, and peer institutions. These are intended as broad, common-sense best practices; individual schools and departments may adapt or supplement them in ways that make sense for their disciplines, pedagogies, and learning goals.

For Students

As a Rutgers University student, you are entering a learning environment where AI tools are provided by the University; however, the authorization of use for these tools and the expectations for appropriate use will be set by the individual instructor for each course. The following guidelines are provided to help you understand how to use those tools responsibly and intelligently.

1. **Use only university-authorized AI resources when available.**
   Rutgers University has approved and provided certain AI tools for use by community members. A full list is available here. You are required to use University-provided tools for any Rutgers academic, research, or business purposes. Non-university-licensed tools, including freely available third-party tools, may have weaker privacy or data ownership safeguards, be limited in functionality/interoperability, or present other risks or issues.

2. **Check the course syllabus for the instructor's guidance on AI use.**
   Each instructor is entitled to set expectations regarding the use of AI in their course (while following any unit/school/department policies). You should review the syllabus carefully. If the syllabus or instructor's statements are unclear about whether you may use AI, and if so, how, ask your instructor for clarification. Communication is key.

3. **When you use AI tools, disclose and reflect on their use as directed.**
   If the instructor allows or expects use of an AI tool, then you should follow any instructions about how to document that use (for example, a note in the assignment with the tool's name and how you used it). Even when not explicitly required, a good

practice is to be transparent: note which parts of your work you generated independently, and which parts you used an AI tool to support.

4. **Use AI as a support for your learning, not as a shortcut to submission.**
   AI tools can help you brainstorm ideas, explore alternatives, draft outlines, or check grammar/style. However, you remain responsible for: reflecting on the suggestions, verifying their accuracy, integrating them with your own thoughts, and ensuring that your work meets the learning objectives of the course. Generative AI tools can be useful, but should not replace your individual efforts and creative contributions.

5. **Maintain academic integrity, attribution, and proper citation.**
   For any content generated by an AI tool (text, images, code, or other artefacts) that you incorporate into your submission, follow the instructor's policy (or general academic-honesty standards) about attribution. Do not present generated text as entirely your own independent creation if it is substantially derived from an AI tool.

6. **Do not assume there is a reliable tool to detect AI-generated content.**
   While you may be tempted to rely on "AI-detector" software or expect that your instructor uses one, beware: there is no foolproof way to determine whether text or other content was generated or heavily assisted by AI. As a result, the best strategy is to utilize resources transparently and ethically, rather than relying on detection tools to verify perceived authenticity.

7. **Ask questions when in doubt.**
   If you are uncertain whether using a given AI tool (or using it in a particular way) is permissible in a course, talk with your instructor proactively—before you submit work. Different instructors (and departments, schools) will set different rules.

8. **Reflect on your future readiness.**
   Many of your future employers will expect you to engage with AI tools ethically and effectively, so use your time here as an opportunity to develop your skills in discerning when AI is helpful, how to ask good prompts, how to critically evaluate AI output, and how to integrate it responsibly into your workflow.

For Instructors

As a Rutgers University instructor, you play a key role in guiding how AI tools are integrated (or not) in your courses. The following best practices are designed to support you in determining the appropriate level of AI use in your course and clearly communicating your expectations to students, ensuring transparency, intentionality, and a positive overall experience for both you and your students. These recommended best practices are intended to complement your pedagogical judgement and should align with any applicable school/department/unit policies. Instructional designers in your unit are resources for additional support.

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2. **Determine if and how AI will be used in your course.**
   Research shows that many institutions emphasize the importance of role-specific and course-level governance of AI. Instructors should determine whether students will be asked to use AI tools in their course and, if so, describe the ways AI will be used. This decision should align with any departmental or school policy and your learning objectives for the course.

3. **Include a clear syllabus statement on AI use.**
   Setting expectations around the use of AI is critical to both student success and limiting potential student conduct violations. Instructors are encouraged to include an AI statement in the course syllabus and to share their reasons for choosing this approach. AI statements could include whether AI tools are permitted, in what ways, how students should document or report their use, what constitutes misuse, and how the use of AI will affect assessment.

4. **Consider revising course activities to reduce the risk of potential misuse of AI.**
   Uncritical use of AI can hinder learning, creativity, and critical thinking. In some cases, revising your course assignments and assessments may reduce the risk of misuse. For example, more in-class or monitored activities, oral components, reflective components, process-oriented assignments, writing samples, or problem-based assessments can mitigate the value of AI misuse.

5. **Recognize limitations of AI detection tools.** Detection of AI generated text is not simple. Studies indicate that AI detection tools have high false positive rates and demonstrate

inherent bias. For these reasons, AI detection tools are not in use at the university and no non-university approved tools should be used.

6. **Consider transparent use of AI in your course.**
   If determined that a course is appropriate for some AI use rather than simply prohibiting it, consider authorizing use but with clear citations of where and how AI was leveraged. For example, require students to include a reflection or statement on how they leveraged AI in their work or have them submit an earlier outline/draft that they developed independently before using AI. This helps maintain the learning process rather than substitute for it.

7. **Promote the use of only AI tools provided by the University to ensure access and reduce security/privacy risk.**
   Directing students to limit AI use in your course to only include university-approved AI tools, thereby reducing potential risks such as the inappropriate sharing of protected data, prevents the unauthorized sharing of the intellectual property of students and faculty, and provides a standardized set of tools to ensure access to all students. Remind them of the possible risks of freely available AI tools, including data ownership, permanence of uploads, model training, bias, privacy, etc.

8. **Model good practices in your own use of AI.**
   If you use AI tools in your own instructional design, course materials, feedback, or communications, consider being transparent with your students about their use. For example: "I used AI to generate suggestions for possible prompts; I then reviewed and adapted them." Modeling reflection and critical evaluation of AI output helps students see how responsible practitioners behave.

9. **Maintain alignment with academic integrity and learning outcomes.**
   Use the AI tool conversation as an opportunity to emphasize the learning goals of your course: critical thinking, creativity, synthesis, ethical reasoning, and discipline-specific skills. Clarify how student use of AI does or does not align with those goals.

10. **Inform students about the limitations of AI tools.**
    Remind students that AI tools are fallible: they may produce inaccurate, biased, or fabricated ("hallucinated") content. Encourage them to critically evaluate any output from an AI tool, verify sources, cross-check facts, and incorporate their own reasoning.

11. **Review and revise your approach each semester.**
    Because AI is changing rapidly, instructors are advised to regularly revisit their AI-use policy and pedagogical practices and alter as needed. Solicit student feedback, monitor

unintended consequences, evaluate the efficacy of the course policy, and adjust your syllabus and practices accordingly.

12. **Use only university-authorized AI resources when available.**
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